

SubmarineDocent

Current site overview and technical summary.

What This Site Is

SubmarineDocent is no longer just a single Pampanito tour prototype. It is now a small FastAPI-backed historical site with several connected experiences:

- A public USS Pampanito audio tour and question-answering app.
- A public diesel-electric submarine FAQ dashboard.
- Special-history sections embedded in the FAQ site for Medal of Honor recipients, Eternal Patrol / lost submarines, incidents, and operations content.
- Curator/admin tools for FAQ review, FAQ editing, and feedback review.

The application is served from one Python backend in [api/main.py](#) and static frontend pages in [web](#).

Current Public Pages

1. Pampanito tour app

Primary visitor experience: [web/pampanito.html](#)

- Mobile-first tour interface for USS Pampanito.
- Supports narrated compartment audio plus visitor Q&A.
- Uses [/ask](#), [/tts](#), [/transcribe](#), [/health](#), and [/contact](#).
- Intended to work as the on-ship or museum-floor docent experience.

2. FAQ dashboard

Primary historical reference hub: [web/faqs.html](#)

- Dashboard of WWII diesel-electric submarine FAQ categories.
- Public FAQ browser backed by [/api/faqs](#).
- Includes four special cards and dedicated in-page views for:
 - U.S. Submarine Medal of Honor recipients.
 - Lost submarines / Eternal Patrol.
 - Submarine incidents database.
 - Operations guide.

This page is currently the most developed general-purpose historical interface in the site.

3. Eternal Patrol page

Standalone lost-submarines page: [web/eternal-patrol.html](#)

- Fetches data from [/api/eternal-patrol](#) with JSONL fallback.
- Shows aggregate statistics, searchable/filterable list, and modal details.
- Modal now includes Construction before Loss Narrative.

4. Feedback and curator tools

- Feedback viewer / gate: <web/feedback.html>
- FAQ review tool: <web/review.html>
- FAQ editor and SQL import tool: web/faq_editor.html

5. Landing page

Current root landing page: <web/index.html>

- Still a placeholder "Coming Soon" page.
- The backend redirects `/` to `/web/index.html` by default, except for `pampanito.*` hostnames which redirect to the Pampanito tour.

Current Backend Surface

Main application file: <api/main.py>

Public routes

- `/` -> redirects to `/web/index.html` or `/web/pampanito.html` depending on host.
- `/pampanito.html` -> redirects to the Pampanito app.
- `/faqs`, `/faqs.html`, `/faq` -> redirect to the FAQ dashboard.
- `/feedback.html`, `/review.html`, `/faq_editor.html` -> redirect to their matching web pages.
- `/web/*` -> static file hosting for the frontend.

Public API routes

- **GET /health**
 - Returns service status, transcription availability, and corpus counts for tour, FAQ, and shorts corpora.
- **POST /ask**
 - Main question-answering endpoint used by the Pampanito app.
- **POST /tts**
 - Text-to-speech endpoint.
- **POST /transcribe**
 - Audio transcription endpoint.
- **POST /contact**
 - Visitor contact / unanswered-question handoff.
- **GET /api/faqs**
 - Returns published `faq_` entries grouped by category for the public FAQ page.
- **GET /api/eternal-patrol**
 - Returns the Eternal Patrol / lost submarines dataset.
- **GET /api/incidents**
 - Returns the submarine incidents dataset.
- **POST /feedback**
 - Accepts simple user feedback submissions.
- **GET /feedback/list**
 - Returns stored feedback entries, intended for admin use.

Admin / curator API routes

- **GET /admin/generated-faqs**
 - Returns generated FAQ candidates (**der_**, **pam_**, **fix_**).
- **GET /admin/faqs**
 - Returns full editable FAQ records.
- **POST /admin/faq**
 - Creates a new published FAQ.
- **PUT /admin/faq/{chunk_id}**
 - Updates an FAQ.
- **POST /admin/faq/{chunk_id}/accept**
 - Promotes a generated FAQ entry into a published **faq_** entry.
- **DELETE /admin/faq/{chunk_id}**
 - Removes generated FAQ entries.
- **POST /admin/import-sql**
 - Imports FAQ content from a phpMyAdmin SQL export.

Data Sources in the Repo

Primary corpora live in [corpora](#).

Current line counts:

Corpus	File	Count	Purpose
Pampanito tour corpus	corpora/pampanito_tour_corpus.jsonl	213	Tour narration / compartment knowledge
Diesel submarine FAQ corpus	corpora/dieselsubs_faq_corpus.jsonl	455	Master FAQ corpus including published and generated entries
Published FAQ entries	corpora/dieselsubs_faq_corpus.jsonl	229	Public faq_ entries exposed through /api/faqs
DieselSubs shorts	corpora/dieselsubs_shorts_corpus.jsonl	31	Supplementary historical snippets
Eternal Patrol	corpora/eternal_patrol.jsonl	65	Lost submarines data
Incidents	corpora/incidents.jsonl	16	Incidents database records

Other notable data/config files:

- [corpora/retrieval_config.yaml](#)
- [corpora/system_prompt_ai_docent.md](#)
- [feedback.jsonl](#)
- [corpora/api_contract.json](#)

How the Site Behaves Today

Pampanito experience

The Pampanito app remains the AI-docent portion of the project:

- compartment-aware visitor Q&A
- text-to-speech answers
- optional server-side transcription
- visitor contact escalation when no good answer is available

FAQ and history experience

The FAQ site has grown into a broader historical reference portal:

- category browsing across published diesel-electric submarine FAQs
- embedded special sections for awardees, losses, incidents, and operations
- dashboard-style navigation rather than a single search page

Curator workflow

Curators can now:

- review generated FAQ candidates
- edit or create FAQ entries directly
- import FAQ material from SQL exports
- review accumulated visitor feedback

Deployment and Hosting Model

Repository memory and config indicate the current deployment model is:

- FastAPI backend with static frontend assets
- Render deployment via [render.yaml](#)
- workspace rooted at `/Users/irving/Documents/submarinedocent`

The repo still contains local HTTPS startup helpers used during local/dev or on-prem usage:

- [serve_https.py](#)
- [start_https.sh](#)

Current State Summary

As of March 2026, the site is best understood as a multi-surface historical web application with one backend and several distinct user experiences:

- The Pampanito tour app is functional and still central.
- The FAQ site is the main public historical dashboard.
- Eternal Patrol and Incidents are now real data-backed features, not placeholders.
- Admin tooling for FAQ curation is present and working.
- The top-level landing page is still a placeholder and does not yet present the full site clearly.

Recommended Next Documentation Updates

- Replace the placeholder root landing page with a true home page that matches the actual site structure.
- Add a dedicated architecture doc for the FAQ dashboard and history datasets.
- Add a curator workflow doc covering review, edit, import, and feedback moderation.
- Add a route map doc separating public, admin, and data endpoints.